

you the best of both worlds. The first line after the comments is `\documentclass{beamer}`. So Beamer is just another LaTeX document class. Good, just the thing I promised.

The theme for your presentation is specified using `\usetheme{Darmstadt}`. You can view all the current themes installed in `/usr/share/texmf/tex/latex/beamer/themes/theme`. Then you specify other appearance-specific settings such as the template, font, etc. After specifying the author and the title, the main document or the presentation starts from `\begin{document}`, and a new slide is enclosed by `\begin{frame}` and `\end{frame}`. Let us now create a new presentation and learn more while we put to use what we have already learnt.

Creating a new presentation

We will create a slide deck consisting of a *Title* slide, a *Table of Contents* and two other slides—*Introduction* and *Summary*. Listing 1 gives the complete code for the `.tex` file, which we will call `example.tex`:

% A simple presentation in LaTeX using Beamer
% Can be used as a template for larger, specific presentations
% example.tex

```
\documentclass{beamer}

\mode<presentation>
{
    \usetheme{Berkeley}
    \setbeamercovered{transparent}
}

\usepackage[english]{babel}
\usepackage[latin1]{inputenc}

\usepackage{times}
\usepackage[T1]{fontenc}

\title{Beam it with Beamer}

\subtitle{Presentations in LaTeX}

\author{Amit Saha}
```

```
\date{October 1, 2009/ LFY}

\begin{document}

\begin{frame}
\titlepage
\end{frame}

\begin{frame}\Outline
\tableofcontents
\end{frame}

\section{Introduction}

\begin{frame}(What is Beamer?)(Beam it up!)
\begin{itemize}
\item A LaTeX class for creating high quality presentations.
\end{itemize}
\end{frame}

\section{Summary}

\begin{frame}(Did we like Beamer?)

\begin{itemize}
\item Yes!
\end{itemize}
\end{frame}

\end{document}
```

Some of the LaTeX elements are generic to any LaTeX document, such as `\title`, `\author` and `\usepackage`. Here are some Beamer-specific elements:

- **New Slide:** A slide is enclosed by `\begin{frame}` and `\end{frame}`.
- **New Section:** The section name before a `\begin{frame}` is the entry for the new slide in the *Table of Contents*, generated by `\tableofcontents`.

You can now compile the LaTeX file similarly. With what we have learnt so far, we can easily create presentations that would contain only text.

More things to try out

- **Working with graphics:** Working with images here is the same as you would do for any LaTeX document class by making use of the *graphics* or *graphicsx* package.



Figure 1: An example presentation created using Beamer

- **Using multimedia in your slides:** Beamer ships with the *multimedia* package that you can use to insert sound, animation or movies. I haven't tried this feature. So you will have to use it to see how well it works!
- **Notes and handouts:** Besides creating the presentation, you might also want to create notes for yourself or to distribute as handouts. Beamer class also has support for creating these.

Still hooked?

If you have been following this article and at the same time typing in some of the LaTeX class, I am hoping that Beamer has impressed you, or at the very least, you'll now consider it as an option. The Beamer user guide has a lot more detailed information on the topics I have touched and more, and is a very handy reference while you create your presentation. For queries, doubts and suggestions, please feel free to e-mail me. 

Resources

- Beamer: latex-beamer.sourceforge.net
- Beamer Documentation: in `/usr/share/doc/latex-beamer` or in your source tarball
- LaTeX resources: en.wikipedia.org/wiki/LaTeX#Further_reading

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